

Problem

UA version

Life on the Pokrovsk Direction

On the Pokrovsk front, we have once again found ourselves inside a pocket. We are being hit from three sides. As always, we are holding our ground, but it comes at a heavy cost — in energy, blood, and equipment.

Our kill zone stretches for more than 17 kilometers. Vehicles cannot reach our positions, and we do not have enough ground robots, so our Mavic reconnaissance teams have to carry their equipment by hand.

For the past year, we have operated as an Unmanned Systems Company with 11 positions. I am responsible for three heavy bomber drone positions: two Vampire positions and one FPV mining team. Recently, I was also assigned responsibility for two additional heavy drone positions from another battalion.

A Special Operation

Recently, we carried out a special operation that took three days to plan.

The Mavic operators moved into position carrying only their personal belongings, controllers, and tablets.

Everything else needed for their position was delivered by the Vampire team, including:

- Control cables
- Antennas
- Electrical wiring
- Water, food, and fuel

- Portable power station
- Chargers, cables, and drone batteries
- Daytime and nighttime drones

Everything was delivered except for the generator and mast, which were already at the position.

We even packed a small portable power station inside a fabric softener container. We tested it by dropping it from half a meter, and the brand-new unit survived without damage.

The Problem

The equipment is expensive. Most of it is purchased by volunteers.

When the Mavic operators first moved in, the situation was still relatively manageable. But once the reconnaissance position is discovered and attacked, evacuation becomes difficult. Heavy equipment is often left behind and eventually destroyed by enemy fire.

Last November was a particularly successful month for volunteer support. One volunteer donated two large Fossibot F2400 power stations. Even on sale, each unit costs around €639.

The problem is that our German supporters cannot simply send money directly to us.

Because donations in Germany receive tax benefits, the logistics chain becomes extremely long and complicated.

Current Process

1. Money is raised through an auction that usually takes about two weeks.
2. The power station must be purchased and shipped to a volunteer's home.
3. It is then transported to the Netherlands, to the home of the leader of EyesOnUkraine.
4. Everyone waits until a military chaplain-driver is traveling through Europe.

5. The chaplain transports the aid either to a volunteer hub in Stryi or to Chernivtsi.
6. In Chernivtsi, Valentina sorts the shipments, prepares foundation paperwork, assigns recipients, and sends everything through Nova Poshta.
7. Only then does the equipment finally reach the military.

A Better Solution

If I can establish local production of large power banks in Ukraine, the process would become much simpler:

1. Funds are raised in Germany.
2. Components such as wiring and control boards are ordered from AliExpress.
3. Components are lighter, require smaller packages, and take up less space in vehicles. They also attract less attention from customs and border officials than fully assembled devices.
4. We assemble the power stations locally and distribute them directly to the units that need them.

The most expensive part of any power station is the battery cells. We already have many damaged battery packs available. They simply need to be sorted, tested, recharged, and rebuilt into a form factor that better suits military needs.

I will tell the story of my "Vampire Laboratory" project in a separate document.